



AERIAL PICTURES SHOW THE MELTING OF LARGE GLACIERS

DESPITE THE HIMALAYAN BLUNDER OVER THE DATE OF THE GLACIER MELTING, THE THREAT REMAINS AND REQUIRES MORE URGENT RESEARCH.

"Approximations from the media should not be included in the IPCC report, which should be based on published papers in peer-reviewed journals," Hasnain emphasises. He blames the authors of the section for poor writing and the IPCC reviewing system which failed to remove the mistakes.

A report released last year by Dr Vijay Kumar Raina, former deputy director-general of the Geological Survey of India, challenged the assumptions of the IPCC report by stating that the rate of decline of the Himalayan glaciers was not abnormal. Pachauri, then, did not show any

of the contriteness which he displayed when the IPCC mistakes came to light. Instead, to quote Pachauri, he "fired from the hip", dismissing the report as "voodoo science" and way below the peer-reviewed reports adopted by the IPCC. He also pointed out that Raina's work hasn't been peer reviewed and there were contradictions in its conclusions.

It now turns out that the 2035 date was not the only error in 'Glaciergate'. IPCC sceptics accuse the panel of cherry-picking—taking facts that prove their hypothesis and ignoring other as was the case with the IPCC panel's claim in 2007, linking

global warming with an increase in floods and hurricanes being drawn from an unpublished study that actually claimed there was insufficient evidence to claim the relationship. The IPCC has denied the charge and says it provided a "balanced treatment of a complicated and important issue".

Another British newspaper has found that even the IPCC's dire predictions that "up to 40 per cent of the Amazonian rainforest could react drastically to a slight change in precipitation" came from another WWF report prepared by two persons who weren't even Amazon specialists. The IPCC is yet to react to this charge.

"The errors are unsettling, but it would be an overreaction to question the credibility of climate science as a whole. The attack on Pachauri has to be seen in the context of an ongoing campaign to discredit climate science," says Lavanya Rajamani of the Centre for Policy Research. Yet, policy analysts say the damage is far worse. "The IPCC's credibility has taken a huge beating in the past year.